

Turquoise Bay

Tour Guide · Cape Range National Park, Western Australia

About the Beach

Turquoise Bay is one of Australia's most famous beaches, located inside Cape Range National Park near Exmouth in Western Australia. It is part of the Ningaloo Coast World Heritage Area.

The beach is known for its bright turquoise water, white sand, and excellent snorkelling. Ningaloo Reef sits very close to the shore, so you can swim and snorkel over coral without needing a boat.

Quick Facts

Location	Cape Range National Park, ~60 km from Exmouth, WA
Known for	Turquoise water, white sand, shore snorkelling
Reef	Part of Ningaloo Reef (World Heritage)
Access	By car into the national park
Facilities	Toilets and parking; limited other services
Entry	National park entry fee applies

Best Time to Visit

The most popular period is **April to October** (dry season), when the weather is milder and conditions are generally good for snorkelling. Summer (November–March) can be very hot.

For snorkelling, higher tides are usually better. Check local tide information.

How to Get There

Turquoise Bay is inside Cape Range National Park. The nearest town is Exmouth.

By Car (Main Option)

- From Exmouth, drive about 45–60 minutes into the national park along Yardie Creek Road.
- Follow signs to Turquoise Bay.
- There are two main parking areas: Drift Loop and Bay Loop.
- Park entry fees apply (pay at the park entry station).
- Arrive early on weekends and holidays — parking fills up.

Getting to Exmouth

- Fly into Learmonth Airport (near Exmouth) from Perth (about 90 minutes flight).
- Then drive or take a transfer into town and on to the park.

What to Do

- **Snorkel** — The main attraction. You can snorkel straight from the beach over coral and fish.
- **Drift snorkel** — Enter near the southern end and let the current carry you (follow local signs and exit points carefully).
- Swim and relax on the white sand.
- Look for turtles, colourful fish and coral close to shore.

Safety note: Currents can be strong, especially near the sandbar and the northern end. Always follow the signs, know your exit point, and only snorkel if you are a confident swimmer.

What to Bring

- Snorkel gear (mask, snorkel, fins) — none for hire at the beach
- Reef-safe sunscreen, hat, and sunglasses
- Plenty of water and snacks
- Beach towel and swimwear
- Cash or card for park entry if needed
- Bag for rubbish

Facilities

There are toilets and parking areas. There is no shop, café or equipment hire on the beach. Bring everything you need for the day.

Useful Tips

1. Arrive early — parking is limited and the beach is popular.
2. Check tides and current conditions before snorkelling.
3. Stay aware of the current if you do the drift snorkel and exit at the marked point.
4. This is a protected marine area — look but do not touch or take anything.
5. There is little shade — bring sun protection.
6. No dogs are allowed in the park.

Information compiled for 2026. Always check current park alerts, road conditions and tide times before visiting.

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